UP

UPSTARS

HUMAN RESOURCE MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

Complete End-to-End Tutorial & User Guide

A practical walkthrough of every module, role, and daily workflow in the UPstars HRMS Platform — with demo credentials, step-by-step examples, and FAQs.

Multi-tenant SaaS MVP | JWT + RBAC | Attendance · Leave · Assets | People · Docs · Reports

PRODUCT
UPstars HRMS Platform

LOCAL URLS
App :3000 · API :5001

GUIDE VERSION
1.0 · October 2026

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> **Theme note**
> This document uses the same visual language as the product: Navy `#0B1F33`, Gold `#C9A227`, and Brand green `#0F6B4C`.

1. About this guide & how to use the demo

UPstars HRMS is a standalone multi-tenant Human Resource Management System (not linked to the recruitment CRM). The frontend is a React SPA; the backend is an Express + TypeScript modular monolith using Sequelize.

What you will learn

- How every major screen works and who can open it
- Complete check-in → work day → check-out flow (including the 5-second cancel shortcut)
- How HR, managers, and admins approve leave, corrections, documents, and assets
- How to run reports and read the audit trail

Local access

Layer	Folder	URL
Web app	`hrms_FE`	http://localhost:3000
API	`hrms_BE`	http://localhost:5001/api/v1

> **Demo password (all seeded users)**
> `Ullas@Intern` — emails end with `@upstars.in`.

2. Getting started — sign in & workspace tour

Sign in

1. **Open** http://localhost:3000 — you land on the branded login screen (UPSTARS gold wordmark, navy atmosphere, soft cursor glow).
2. **Enter** a demo email (e.g. `employee@upstars.in`) and password `Ullas@Intern`.
3. **Submit** — the API returns a JWT and your roles/permissions. The app stores the token and loads the protected shell.
4. **Forgot password** — use `/forgot-password` then `/reset-password` when a reset token is issued (demo environments may log the link server-side).

Workspace layout

Area	What it does
Left sidebar	Module navigation filtered by your permissions
Top header	Search (coming soon), live attendance timer when checked in, **Check out** shortcut, notifications, Logout, profile menu
Main canvas	Dashboard KPIs and module pages

> **Logout vs Check out**
> **Logout** signs you out immediately and does *not* punch attendance. **Check out** (next to the running timer) starts a **5-second cancel banner**, then records check-out only.

3. Roles, users & permissions

Access is role-based (RBAC). Menus and API routes require the matching permission key.

Seeded demo users

Name	Email	Role	Typical focus
MD Paizal	admin@upstars.in	Company Admin	Full org, settings, audit, all modules
Dhanush	hr@upstars.in	HR Manager	People, leave types, onboarding, docs, reports
Jaishanth	manager@upstars.in	Manager	Team attendance/leave approvals, tasks
Ullas Kumar	employee@upstars.in	Employee	Self check-in, leave request, tasks, own profile
Neha Iyer	assets@upstars.in	Asset Manager	Asset register, assign / return

Permission families (summary)

Family	Examples
Employees / Org	employee:view/create/update/import · org:manage
Attendance	attendance:checkin · correct · approve · view_team
Leave	leave:request · approve · manage_types
Assets	asset:manage · asset:assign
Documents	document:manage · generate · approve
Teams / Onboarding	team:manage · onboarding:manage
Reports / Audit	report:view/export · audit:view

> **Tip**
> If a menu item is missing, your role does not include that permission — this is expected, not a bug.

4. Module catalogue (all resources)

Nav	Route	Primary resources
Home	`/`	Dashboard KPIs, snapshots
Employees	`/people/employees`	Employee CRUD, detail, deactivate
Import	`/people/employees/import`	CSV bulk import
Departments	`/people/departments`	Org departments
Branches	`/people/branches`	Office locations
Designations	`/people/designations`	Job titles
Onboarding	`/people/onboarding`	Checklists & items
Attendance	`/attendance`	Punch, corrections, team view, approvals
Leave	`/leave`	Types, balances, requests, approvals
Assets	`/assets`	Register, assignments lifecycle
Teams	`/teams`	Teams & memberships
Tasks	`/tasks`	Work items / status
Documents	`/documents`	Templates & generated PDFs
Reports	`/reports`	Attendance/leave/assets CSV exports
Company	`/settings/company`	Tenant / company settings
Roles	`/settings/roles`	Role & permission matrix
Audit	`/audit`	Immutable activity log

Out of MVP Payroll engine, recruitment ATS, chat, and sales CRM are intentionally not in this product.

5. End-to-end — People & organisation

5.1 Organisation setup (Admin / HR)

Example actor: **admin@upstars.in** or **hr@upstars.in**.

1. Open **People** → **Branches**. Create or edit “HQ Bangalore” (or your city office).
2. Open **Departments**. Ensure Engineering, HR, Sales (or your structure) exist.
3. Open **Designations**. Add titles such as Software Engineer, HR Manager.
4. Open **Settings** → **Company** to confirm tenant name and timezone (demo uses Asia/Kolkata).

5.2 Hire / create an employee

1. Go to **People** → **Employees** → add employee (form modal).
2. Fill employee number, full name, email, department, designation, branch, joining date, manager.
3. Save — the person appears in the directory. Open the detail page for status, contacts, and related records.
4. **Bulk path:** `/people/employees/import` — upload CSV, review mapping/errors, commit.

5.3 Onboarding checklist

1. Open **People** → **Onboarding** (needs `onboarding:manage`).
2. Create or open a checklist; tick items (laptop issued, policy signed, accounts created).
3. Track completion until the new joiner is marked ready for day-one attendance.

6. End-to-end — Attendance & leave

6.1 Daily check-in (Employee)

Example actor: **employee@upstars.in** (Ullas Kumar).

1. Sign in → open **Attendance**.
2. Tap the large **Check in** control. Optionally share location when prompted (geofence may flag outside punches).
3. Header updates live: timer shows `HH:MM:SS` total for today. Status flips from "Not checked in".
4. Work normally. Timer keeps counting without refreshing the page.

6.2 Check-out shortcut (5-second cancel)

1. In the header, click **Check out** beside the timer.
2. A navy/gold banner appears: "Checking out in 5s". Click **Cancel** if it was accidental.
3. If you let the countdown finish, the API records `CHECK_OUT`, the timer stops, and the shortcut hides.
4. You can also check out from the Attendance page punch control — same API, no countdown.

6.3 Corrections & approvals

1. Employee: Attendance → Corrections → request a missed punch (date, type, time, reason).
2. Manager/HR: open Approvals tab → Approve or Reject with an optional note.
3. On approve, a corrected attendance event is created and appears in history.

6.4 Team attendance (Manager)

Login as **manager@upstars.in** → Attendance → **Team** tab → pick a date → review punches for reports.

6.5 Leave request → approve

1. **Employee:** Leave → create request (type, from/to, reason). Balance is validated.
2. **Manager/HR:** Leave → Approvals → Approve/Reject.
3. **HR:** manage leave types and opening balances when permitted.

> **Geofence**
> Admins can configure geofences under the API/settings path. Check-ins outside the fence may be flagged for review while still recorded.

7. End-to-end — Assets, teams, tasks, documents

7.1 Assets lifecycle (Asset Manager)

Actor: **assets@upstars.in**.

1. Open **Assets** → add a laptop/phone (tag, serial, category, status).
2. Assign to an employee → employee acknowledges → later mark return.
3. Track assignment history from the asset / assignment views.

7.2 Teams & tasks

1. **Teams:** create a team, add members (manager needs team permissions).
2. **Tasks:** create tasks, assign owners, move status (open → in progress → done).
3. Employees see tasks relevant to them on `/tasks`.

7.3 Documents

1. HR creates/maintains a **document template** (offer letter, experience letter, etc.).
2. Generate a document for an employee → review → approve when required → download PDF.
3. Generated documents remain listed under Documents for auditability.

8. End-to-end — Reports, settings & audit

8.1 Reports

Open **Reports** (needs report permissions). Pick a pack such as Attendance, Leave, or Assets; set a date range when prompted; export CSV.

8.2 Settings → Roles

Company Admin opens **Settings** → **Roles** to inspect the permission matrix. Seeded roles (COMPANY_ADMIN, HR_MANAGER, MANAGER, EMPLOYEE, ASSET_MANAGER) are the source of truth from backend role definitions.

8.3 Audit log

Open **Audit** to see who changed what (create/update/approve/reject). Use this after sensitive actions (role changes, corrections, document approvals).

8.4 Notifications

The header bell shows in-app notifications (approvals, assignments). Mark as read from the menu.

9. Role playbooks — complete day-in-the-life

Company Admin — MD Paizal

Login: admin@upstars.in

1. Review Dashboard KPIs
2. Confirm Company settings & Roles
3. Spot-check Audit after HR changes
4. Export monthly Attendance report

HR Manager — Dhanush

Login: hr@upstars.in

1. Add / import new joiners
2. Run onboarding checklist
3. Approve leave & issue documents
4. Maintain leave types & org masters

Manager — Jaishanth

Login: manager@upstars.in

1. Own check-in for the day
2. Review Team attendance tab
3. Approve leave / corrections
4. Assign and track team tasks

Employee — Ullas Kumar

Login: employee@upstars.in

1. Check in (share location if asked)
2. Work — watch header timer
3. Request leave or correction if needed
4. Check out via header shortcut (cancel within 5s if mis-click)

Asset Manager — Neha Iyer

Login: assets@upstars.in

1. Register new hardware in Assets
2. Assign to employee → wait for acknowledgement
3. Process returns / update status
4. Use Reports → Assets when inventory reviews are due

Complete employee day (copy-paste scenario)

1. 08:55 — Login as employee@upstars.in
2. 09:00 — Attendance → Check in (allow location)
3. 09:01 — Confirm header shows running timer + Check out button
4. 12:30 — (Optional) Accidental Check out → Cancel within 5 seconds
5. 14:00 — Leave → request 1 day Casual Leave next week
6. 18:05 — Header Check out → let countdown finish
7. 18:06 — Logout (session ends; attendance already closed)
8. Next morning — Manager approves the leave request

10. Frequently asked questions (FAQs)

Why does the header say “Not checked in” even after I punched?

Your user must be linked to an employee record (`employeeId`). After a product update that fixed camelCase mapping, reload once, then punch again — the timer should update live without another refresh.

Does Logout also check me out?

No. Logout only ends the session. Use the header **Check out** button (or the Attendance page) to close your attendance.

What is the 5-second banner for?

It protects against accidental check-out from the header shortcut. Press Cancel to stay checked in. After 5 seconds the check-out is submitted.

I don’t see Employees / Settings / Audit in the menu.

Those links are permission-gated. Sign in with a role that has the required permission (e.g. admin or HR), or ask an admin to adjust roles under Settings → Roles.

Can I use this with the Recruitment CRM?

No — UPstars HRMS is a standalone product. It is not wired to the recruitment CRM repositories.

Which database does local demo use?

SQLite by default for easy localhost setup. Production can use PostgreSQL via Sequelize configuration.

My check-in was flagged.

Location was missing, inaccurate, or outside an active geofence. The punch is still stored; managers/HR can review flagged entries and corrections.

How do I reset a demo password?

Re-run the backend seed (`npm run db:seed` in `hrms_BE`) to restore `Ullas@Intern` for all demo users, or use the forgot-password flow if enabled.

Where do API calls go?

Browser → `/api/v1/…` with Bearer JWT. Backend middleware authenticates, enforces RBAC, then hits the matching service (attendance, leave, employees, …).

Is payroll / recruitment included?

Not in this MVP. Navigation intentionally omits payroll, recruitment ATS, chat, and sales CRM.

Timezone issues on “today’s” attendance?

The app uses your browser’s local calendar day for “today” bounds so early-morning punches (e.g. IST) are not cut off by UTC midnight.

Who can approve leave and attendance corrections?

Users with `leave:approve` / `attendance:approve` — typically Manager and HR roles in the seed data.

How do notifications work?

In-app notifications are listed from the header bell. They cover events such as approvals and assignments depending on what the backend emits.

Can multiple people be checked in on one account?

Attendance is scoped to the signed-in user’s linked employee. Each person should use their own login.

Where is the official product branding?

Login and shell use the UPstars wordmark in gold on navy, subtitle “Human Resource Management System” / “HRMS Platform”, without a circular logo treatment.

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